

**Current Affairs • Week 40 • 28 Sep – 4 Oct 2026****18 min**

READING TIME

10

KEY STORIES

40

IN BRIEF

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MCQS + MAINS

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PAPER MIX

01 – THE WEEK IN 2 MINUTES**The 6 stories you can't skip****1 EC directs officers to enroll eligible voters after 13.3 crore names deleted**

Why it matters: The Election Commission of India directed Chief Electoral Officers to conduct a special drive to re-enroll eligible voters following the deletion of...

GS2 • POLITY & CONSTITUTION

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2 UNFCCC Executive Secretary praises Rs 1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

Why it matters: UNFCCC Executive Secretary Simon Stiell praised India's approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) for its scale in evacuating renewable ener...

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3 Sarvjeet Singh Virk, Co-founder & MD of Shoonya

Why it matters: SEBI's FY25-26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses, highlighting risks in retail participation in c...

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4 Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

Why it matters: PM Modi and Donald Trump held a telephone call to review bilateral ties and trade amidst discussions on the Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia a...

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5 Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

Why it matters: President Donald Trump signed the 'White House Accord on Super Intelligence' with major AI firms (Meta, Nvidia, Google, etc.) to establish voluntary...

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6 East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

Why it matters: The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that the 2026 southwest monsoon was significantly below normal, with the East and Northeast region...

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What to know, in 60 seconds each

10 of 244 notes · picked for exam value

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EC directs officers to enroll eligible voters after 13.3 crore names deleted

Why in news: The Election Commission of India directed Chief Electoral Officers to conduct a special drive to re-enroll eligible voters following the deletion of 13.3 crore names from voter lists.

REMEMBER

- Election Commission of India (ECI) is the constitutional body responsible for administering elections to Parliament and State Legislatures.
- Approximately 13.3 crore names were deleted from voter lists leading to the current rectification drive.
- Form 6 is the specific application form used for the enrollment of new voters in the electoral roll.

MAINS ANGLE *Examine the challenges in maintaining an accurate and inclusive electoral roll in India and suggest measures to ensure universal suffrage.*

USE : Universal Adult Franchise Electoral Roll

Constitutional Mandate Inclusivity

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/129344

GS3 · ECONOMY

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Sarvjeet Singh Virk, Co-founder & MD of Shoonya

Why in news: SEBI's FY25–26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses, highlighting risks in retail participation in complex financial instruments.

REMEMBER

- 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses in the FY25–26 SEBI study
- Options trading accounted for 92% of the total losses in equity derivatives
- Transaction costs of Rs 24,859 crore impacted the profitability of 4.4 lakh traders

MAINS ANGLE *Discuss the risks associated with retail participation in complex derivative products and suggest measures to enhance investor protection in capital markets.*

USE : Investor Protection Information Asymmetry

Market Volatility Financial Literacy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/129363

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UNFCCC Executive Secretary praises Rs 1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

Why in news: UNFCCC Executive Secretary Simon Stiell praised India's approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) for its scale in evacuating renewable energy.

REMEMBER

- GEC-III total project outlay: Rs 1.86 lakh crore
- Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) capacity: 50 GWh
- Renewable energy evacuation target: 135 GW

MAINS ANGLE *Examine how the development of large-scale battery energy storage systems and transmission corridors can address the intermittency challenges of India's renewable energy transition.*

USE : Renewable Energy Transition Grid Stability

Energy Storage Systems Decarbonization

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/129406

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Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

Why in news: PM Modi and Donald Trump held a telephone call to review bilateral ties and trade amidst discussions on the Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act.

REMEMBER

- The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes tariffs of up to 100% on specific imports.
- S. Jaishankar serves as the External Affairs Minister of India.
- The act targets countries importing Russian oil as a means of economic pressure.

MAINS ANGLE *Analyze how the proposed Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act could impact India's strategic autonomy and its energy security goals.*

USE : Strategic Autonomy Energy Security Trade Policy

Geopolitical Pressure

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128655

Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

Why in news: President Donald Trump signed the 'White House Accord on Super Intelligence' with major AI firms (Meta, Nvidia, Google, etc.) to establish voluntary guardrails and oversight for advanced AI development.

REMEMBER

- White House Accord on Super Intelligence: A voluntary pact between the US government and major AI firms for safety oversight.
- OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic: Key private entities involved in the development of Large Language Models and Super Intelligence.
- Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act: A legislative proposal aimed at prohibiting the development of super-intelligent AI systems.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the necessity of multi-stakeholder governance frameworks in regulating Artificial Super Intelligence to balance technological innovation with global safety standards.

USE: Algorithmic accountability Technological sovereignty

Safety guardrails Multi-stakeholder governance

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128627

East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

Why in news: The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that the 2026 southwest monsoon was significantly below normal, with the East and Northeast regions recording their driest monsoon since 1901.

REMEMBER

- India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).
- El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.

MAINS ANGLE Analyze the impact of El Nino and climate change on the variability of the Indian monsoon and its implications for food security.

USE: El Nino Monsoon Variability Climate Resilience

Meteorological Forecasting

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128578

Supreme Court to Examine Threat to Press Freedom in The Hindu Case

Why in news: The Supreme Court will examine the conflict between legislative privileges and freedom of the press in a 2003 case involving *The Hindu* and the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

REMEMBER

- Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
- Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
- Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.

MAINS ANGLE Examine the constitutional conflict between the privileges of the legislature and the fundamental right to freedom of the press in India.

USE: Freedom of Press Legislative Privilege

Harmonious Construction Fundamental Rights

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128174

Election Chief Faces Petition for Database Tampering, Voter Disenfranchisement

Why in news: A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent audit of Election Commission databases and the removal of statutory immunity for the CEC over alleged electoral roll tampering.

REMEMBER

- Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India.

USE: Electoral Integrity Statutory Immunity

Disenfranchisement Constitutional Democracy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128140

Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers

Why in news: The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green crackers' to balance cultural practices with air quality.

REMEMBER

- CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives
- Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60% compared to traditional crackers

MAINS ANGLE *Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India.*

USE: Precautionary Principle Right to Clean Environment

Regulatory Compliance

Pollution Mitigation

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128805

Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes

Why in news: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to negotiate an interim trade agreement amidst shifting U.S. tariff policies.

REMEMBER

- Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh

MAINS ANGLE *Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition.*

USE: Trade Liberalization Tariff Protectionism

Bilateral Cooperation

Trade Diplomacy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128774

Everything else, one line each

40 more notes · full versions online

GS1 · HISTORY · SOCIETY · GEOGRAPHY

India identifies 28 strategic places and geographical features on official Survey of India map

Five new sites, including Udaigiri Caves, added to India's UNESCO World Heritage tentative list

NCERT Replaces European Revolutions with Medieval India History in Class 9 Textbook

GS2 · POLITY · GOVERNANCE · SOCIAL JUSTICE · IR

Japan urges India to speed up UNICORN radar deal amid Quad naval plans

UAE to invest additional \$25 billion in India, aiming for \$100 billion total

HLCDC Seeks 15-Year Religion-Wise Data, Struggling States Face Constitutional Hurdles

Supreme Court Collegium recommends three High Court Chiefs for top judge roles

Maninder Sidhu and Piyush Goyal aim to scale Canada and India bilateral trade

Russia warns NATO it will use entire arsenal including nuclear weapons over Kaliningrad blockade

US pauses record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as trade bargaining chip

In August 2026, the Supreme Court asked Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes

Union Government Seeks Supreme Court Stay on Great Nicobar Island Project Petitions

Pakistan hosts SCO preparatory meeting; India attends amid Kashmir tensions

India Talks with China to Use Xinjiang Airspace; Flights Set to Resume

Houthis Capture Yemen Ports with IRGC Help, Control Strategic Strait

India's Orphan Drug Potential: 1,004 Rare Disorders, \$100,000+ Treatments Await Solutions

Ladakh Demands Sixth Schedule Status, MHA Proposes Directly Elected Body

Supreme Court Orders Delhi Police to Audit Lighting, CCTV After Recent Rapes

Supreme Court Questions How Minors Can Have Social Media Accounts

India Had 50 Million Schoolchildren Without Sanitation in 2025: WHO/UNICEF Report

GS3 · ECONOMY · S&T · ENVIRONMENT · SECURITY

Modi cabinet approves rabi crop MSP hikes with ₹90,962 crore farmer payout

India to become "super-aged" by 2065 as fertility rate hits 1.9

Half of Indian cybercrime victims complain to police, 27% pay bribes

Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Strategy, Busting 40 Modules Linked to Bhatti Network

RK Singh, India's Defence Secretary, stated at NDTV's Defence Conclave 2026 that the government

Supreme Court takes action on Delhi's gang-rape cases, echoes 2012 Nirbhaya failures

Jessica Watkins becomes first Black woman to lead crew to orbit in record flight

Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders

80% of Mumbaiers refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000

India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04

India's external debt rose \$15.4 billion to \$778.2 billion by end-June

India proposes \$25 billion pool to support Deep Tech startups and reduce foreign dependence

IN-SPACe guidelines require Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads under Space Policy 2023

Omar Yaghi and team win Nobel Prize for extracting water in Death Valley

Centre notifies CAFE-3 norms: Fuel benchmark to drop 16.7% by 2031-32

India Aims for 10 GW Polysilicon by August to Cut China Dependence

Delhi bans non-compliant vehicles from November 1 under strict new Winter Action Plan

Kaveri Derivative Engine Exceeds Target, Reaches 48.5 kN Thrust in Russian Trials

ISRO and CNES are preparing to launch TRISHNA from Sriharikota in 2027

HAL Excluded: Defence Ministry Picks Private Firms for AMCA Prototypes

Mains questions to practise

GS2 · POLITY & CONSTITUTION

Examine the challenges in maintaining an accurate and inclusive electoral roll in India and suggest measures to ensure universal suffrage.

USE : [Universal Adult Franchise](#) [Electoral Roll](#) [Constitutional Mandate](#) [Inclusivity](#) [Demographic Accuracy](#)

GS3 · SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Examine how the development of large-scale battery energy storage systems and transmission corridors can address the intermittency challenges of India's renewable energy transition.

USE : [Renewable Energy Transition](#) [Grid Stability](#) [Energy Storage Systems](#) [Decarbonization](#) [Infrastructure Development](#)



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